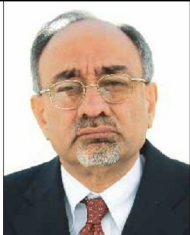


OLEDs REPRESENT THE FUTURE OF DISPLAY TECHNOLOGY



Samtel is a market leader in the manufacture of colour picture tubes (CPTs) and display systems. It holds almost 70 per cent of the CPT market share in India. Samtel is now poised to tap the potentially high-growth OLED segment across the globe which is expected to grow considerably by 2010.

Satish Kaura, chairman and managing director of Samtel, recently spoke to EFY's Uma Bansal on shaping the future of displays

■ SATISH KAURA
CHAIRMAN AND MANAGING DIRECTOR OF SAMTEL

Considering the rise in the popularity of liquid-crystal display (LCD) and plasma TVs, how is the CPT industry faring in India?

The market is still driven by price and value for money, and the price difference between LCD/plasma and CRT-based TVs is pushing up the demand for CRT TVs. CRT-based TVs continue to dominate the market with 16.5 million units sold in 2008, while the sales of LCD and plasma TVs hovered around 750,000 units. For millions of households in small towns, which do not yet have a television set, CRT-based TVs are still the entry-level choice.

Samtel is the largest manufacturer of CPTs and various other components for colour TVs. Are you planning to enter the colour TV market sometime in future?

Our business model has always been B2B, and has been the driving force which has helped us capture and sustain our market share. Over the years, this model has contributed towards building strong alliances with our customers, and we intend to keep it this way.

How important is R&D for Samtel? How would you rate your R&D facilities?

We have an in-house team of highly qualified and experienced engineers, who are consistently working towards enhancing the product experience for our customers. A decade ago, we successfully

designed and launched a 51cm (20-inch) colour picture tube in the market, followed by 53cm (21-inch) super-flat tube and 74cm (29-inch) tube. Our newer lines in Ghaziabad and Kota have been completely designed and developed by our own team of engineers.

Moreover, our avionics display systems division has the distinction of being associated with some mission-critical display systems that will soon be flying in the aerospace. Not just that, Samtel is also working towards indigenising OLED technology in collaboration with IIT Kanpur and Ministry of Science & Technology, and has set up a research centre at IIT Kanpur.

What are OLEDs? How are these different from LCDs and plasma display panels?

Organic light-emitting diodes (OLEDs) are solid-state semiconductor devices composed of thin films of organic molecules that create light with the application of electricity. These are the LEDs whose emissive electroluminescent layer is composed of a film of organic compounds.

OLEDs consume less power than LCD and plasma displays and hence are far better for portable devices. This also makes OLEDs much more environment-friendly, and a candidate for the white-light 'bulb' of the future. OLED screens are brighter, and offer fuller viewing angle, faster refresh rate and

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